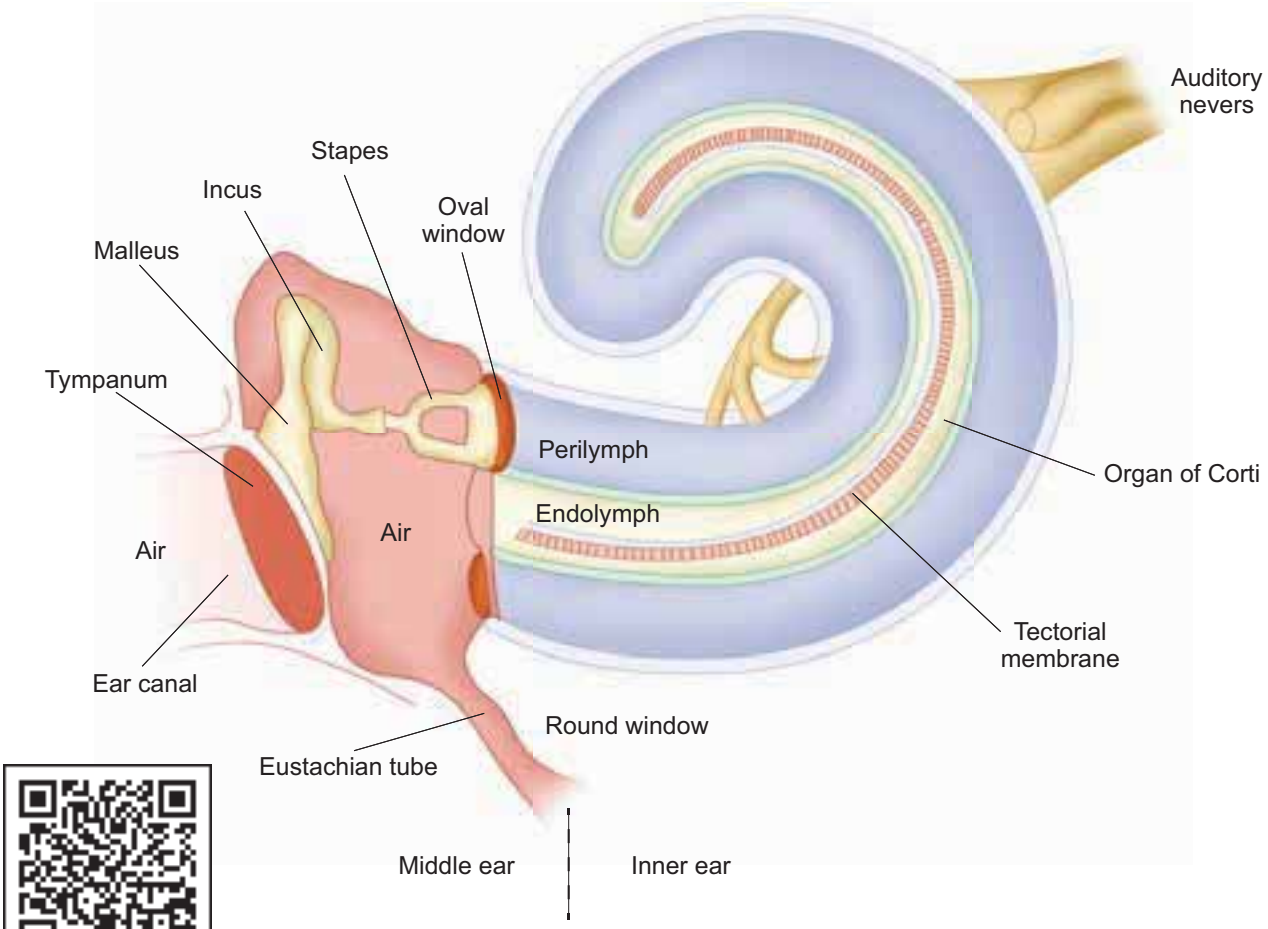
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Figure 10.18 Path of Sound wave

10.6.2 Phonoreceptor

The ear is the site of reception of two senses namely hearing and equilibrium. Anatomically, the ear is divided into three regions: the external ear, the middle ear and internal ear.

The external ear consists of **pinna, external auditory meatus** and **ear drum**. The pinna is flap of elastic cartilage covered by skin. It collects the sound waves. The external auditory meatus is a curved tube that extends up to the tympanic membrane [the ear drum]. The tympanic membrane is composed of connective tissues covered with skin outside and with mucus membrane inside.

There are very fine hairs and wax producing sebaceous glands called **ceruminous glands** in the external auditory meatus. The combination of hair and the **ear wax** [cerumen] helps in preventing dust and foreign particles from entering the ear.

The middle ear is a small air-filled cavity in the temporal bone. It is separated

Name the parts of the organ of equilibrium involved in the following functions.

a) Linear movement of the body

b) Changes in the body position

c) Rotational movement of the head.